

Project Export: Droid Builders UK - NFC/PWA Collection System

Date: May 2, 2026 | Context: Laravel PWA Architecture

USER

I want to make something interactive for people who visit our (droidbuilders uk) stands at comic cons, etc. I'm thinking a way for people to have an app or something on their phone that lets them scan an NFC or QR code to 'register' they've seen a droid.

ASSISTANT

Suggested a **Progressive Web App (PWA)** as the primary platform to avoid app store friction. Key concepts included:

- **Trigger:** NFC tags (NTAG213/215) or QR codes.
- **Collection Mechanic:** Pokemon-style digital registry.
- **Technical Stack:** PHP/Laravel back-end.

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The current portal is written in php using laravel framework. Its a long standing app that has all our member data, their droids, etc. in it. So security is essential.

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Proposed using **Signed URLs** to prevent "URL guessing" and the **Laravel Socialite** package for quick OAuth registration (Google/Apple) at busy events. Suggested a `droid_scans` pivot table for the registry.

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I'd like the end user (non member) part to be totally separate from the portal.
So its own PWA, possibly running laravel.

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Outlined a **Decoupled Architecture**:

1. **Portal (Core):** Serves as the "Source of Truth" via an API.
2. **PWA (Hunters App):** Separate Laravel instance for public engagement.
3. **Redirect Logic:** Portal acts as a "Router" for NFC tags to keep them future-proof.

Security: Server-to-server API keys and rate limiting to protect member data.

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Exporting conversation for IDE import.